



A History of D&D

Dungeons and Dragons turns 40. Here's an interesting blog post outlining the history of the franchise <http://digit.in/dad40>

Unbalanced

19 of the most illogical swords in gaming history are analysed and reassessed based on practical use <http://digit.in/19swords>

'Lotus Feet' the charge had a fuller and richer sound.

Talking about the Charge, it has another trick up its sleeve – the speaker doubles up as a portable powerbank with which you can charge your portable devices on the go. If you think about it, the convergence of these device categories makes perfect sense. A bluetooth speaker is something you'll pull out once in a while from your backpack, maybe at a house party, camping trip, or the occasional commute just to annoy your fellow passengers, but now you don't need to carry another infrequently used device: a portable charger. The JBL Charge leverages the heart of this device – the powerful 6000 mAh battery – beautifully. It makes for a much stronger use case for carrying around another device in your bag. The dual use case and the standard level of performance make the Charge our **Best Buy** in this category.

Next up, we have a go at the **UE Boombox**, the **Bose SoundLink Mobile Speaker II** and the **Bose SoundLink Mini** together. They were the top three performers in the test and it's only fair we talk about them in reference to each other. The UE Boombox is a monstrosity when it comes to its size, but the speaker was one of the few that could at least

READY RECKONER

Here's a quick decision maker for various scenarios and requirements you may have

I want something funky:	The JBL Pulse is the way to go. An LED light show is something even the most level-headed of geeks won't be able to resist.	
I'm on a tight budget:	The Zoook Air Drum ZB-BS100 is the way to go. At an MRP of ₹2,495 and possibly an even lower street price, it's perfect for those on a budget.	
Size is not a problem:	Go for the Logitech UE Boombox. It's huge but you get the boom to shake up the neighbourhood.	
I want something super-portable, has great audio and won't cost a bomb:	What you need is the Logitech UE Mobile Boombox, especially when it's available for half the MRP online.	
I want a speaker and a power bank:	The JBL Charge – A perfect example of convergence that makes sense.	
Superb lows, high fidelity in a small package, price no bar:	The Bose SoundLink Mini. Deceptively loud and sonically brilliant.	
A gift for my valentine OR The ultimate in stereo separation	With 14 th Feb coming up, you need to get yourself two units of the HMDX Jam Plus. The special "His & Hers" collection is available in bright colors of lemon, pink and blue. Pair it together when you meet your significant other.	

give out some amount of thump. The cellos on 'While My Guitar' sounded natural but lacked the vocal and guitar clarity that was present on the Bose SoundLink Mobile Speaker II. As for the *Dream Theater* track, the lower ranges are clearly amplified. What this means is that you get a lot of boom and a fair amount of thump. This gives an impression of a well rounded full range sound even if the the mids are a bit muddled. The highs are not clear enough and bass management is

great. Having said that, the Bose SoundLink Mobile Speaker II was quite a treat when it came to *Massive Attack's* 'Angel'. The lows were clearly the best in the category. Even with 'Lotus Feet' the boses had more clarity.

What of the diminutive Bose SoundLink Mini, you ask? It's a great piece of engineering wizardry to begin with. It's transducers are supposed to move more air for greater bass, and the passive radiators face opposite directions reducing vibrations. And guess what, it works! The ability of this little thing to churn out radiating, room-filling lows was impressive to say the least. 'Call On Me' sounded very clear, pleasing and rich. The only niggle we noticed was this wavy sort of doppler effect on vocals whenever there was a bass attack or the instrumentation density went up. That aside, when you see what exactly is creating the rich room-filling sound you'll keep these aspersions to your-

self and simply go "whoa!" Now comes the lone ranger from Creative – The **Airwave HD**. This speaker is loud and has a thump that's on par with the best. What it lacks is clarity but it atones to some extent (if at all) with loudness.

THE VERDICT

So, which speaker is the best performer? While the Logitech UE Boombox was the loudest speaker in the test, it was also the largest. On the other hand, the Bose SoundLink Mobile Speaker II while being almost as loud was comparatively much smaller. It's performance in terms of overall sound quality was better. So...you guessed it... the Bose SoundLink Mobile Speaker II walks away with the **Best Performer** crown. If you want the best your money can buy, this is the speaker to go for. Having said that, each of the top three performers in this test have a use case they satisfy. Happy listening. 



Bose SoundLink Mobile Speaker II